

71. Who among the following kings had heavily leaned towards Jainism?

- (a) Dashratha (b) Brihadratha
(c) Kharavela (d) Huvishka

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

72. Kalinga's King Kharvel was associated with:

- (a) Mahameghvahana dynasty
(b) Chedi dynasty
(c) Satvahana dynasty
(d) Rath-Bhojak dynasty
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

Kalinga's king Kharavela was best-known king of the Mahameghvahana dynasty (which is also termed as 'Chedi Dynasty' by some scholars).

73. The inscription of Hathigumpha is the source of information about which king?

- (a) Kharvela (b) Ashok
(c) Harshavardhan (d) Kanishka

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The Hathigumpha inscription from Udaigiri, near Bhubaneswar in Odisha, was inscribed by Kharavela. The Hathigumpha inscription is the main source of information about Kalinga ruler Kharavela.

74. What is/are correct in reference to Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves?

- (i) It has both natural and artificial caves
(ii) Udayagiri has 18 and Khandagiri has 15 caves
(iii) Khandagiri caves are famous for Hathigumpha inscription
(a) (i), (ii) and (iii) (b) (i) and (iii)
(c) (i) and (ii) (d) Only (i)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Udayagiri and Khandagiri are hills which are famous for their rock-cut caves. These caves are in Bhubaneswar in Odisha. It has both natural and artificial caves. Udayagiri has 18 and Khandagiri has 15 caves. Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela is obtained from Udayagiri caves.

75. Which field was mostly contributed by Eastern Roman ruler Justinian?

- (a) Law (b) Architecture
(c) Science (d) Literature

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Justinian is known for his contribution and development of Roman law. The Corpus Juris Civilis is still the basis of civil law in many modern states. Justinian was responsible for the complete amendment of Roman Law.

76. Who wrote Periplus of the Erythraean Sea?

- (a) Ctesias
(b) Pliny
(c) Ptolemy
(d) Strabo
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

[64th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (e)

Periplus Maris Erythraei (or 'Voyage around the Erythraean sea') is an anonymous work from around the middle of the first century CE written by a Greek-speaking merchant. It was translated by Wilfred H. Schoff as The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea : Travel and Trade in the Indian Ocean by a Merchant of the first century.

77. Consider the following statements in the context of ancient trade :

1. There are references of numerous river ports in ancient India.

2. There were large entrepôts of goods and traffic.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Neither 1 nor 2
(c) Only 1 (d) Only 2

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

In ancient India, rivers and ports were major centers of trade and transport. During the Indus Valley Civilization, ports like Lothal, as well as warehouses at Harappa and Mohenjo-daro, provide evidence of large trading hubs. In historical times, rivers like the Ganga, Indus and Kaveri served as important routes for trade and transportation. Ports such as Muziris and Sopara were famous for trade with Rome and Southeast Asia. In ancient India, large warehouses were used for the storage of goods, which facilitated trade. Thus, both statements 1 and 2 are true.

Gupta and Post-Gupta Period

*Gupta dynasty ruled during 275-550 AD. This dynasty was established by King **Srigupta** around 275 AD, but the first powerful ruler of Gupta dynasty was **Chandragupta I** who ruled during 319-335 AD. He held the title of 'Maharajadhiraja' (in contradiction to his predecessors) to show his importance. *Gupta Samvat was started by **Chandragupta-I** in 319 A.D.

*Historian **V. A. Smith** in his composition '**The Early History of India**' called **Samudragupta (335-375 A.D.)** of Gupta dynasty as '**Napoleon of India**' for his great military conquests. The **Ashoka pillar inscription** of Allahabad (Prayagraj) is associated with **Samudragupta (335-375 AD)**. It is considered to be the most important historical document of the classical Gupta age in excellent Sanskrit written by **Harisena**. It is also known as '**Prayag Prashasti**'. *The inscription is a panegyric (tribute) praising Samudragupta and lists the political and military achievements of his reign including his expeditions to the south. Built by **Ashoka**, originally it was situated in Kaushambi, which was later shifted to Allahabad (Prayagraj) by **Akbar**. The name of **Jahangir** and **Birbal** is also mentioned there.

*Prayag Prashasti is on the Ashokan Pillar but has 4 different inscriptions:

- (1) Ashokan inscription in Brahmi script
- (2) Queen edict regarding the charitable deed of Ashoka's wife, Karuvaki.
- (3) Samudragupta inscription written by Harisena in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script.
- (4) Jahangir inscription in Persian.

*Another name of Gupta ruler **Chandragupta –II 'Vikramaditya'** (375-415 AD) is found as **Dev Gupta**. Its evidence has been obtained from Sanchi and Vakataka inscriptions. Apart from the above-mentioned names, he is also known as **Devraja** and **Devashri**.

*According to **Mehrauli inscription** the king Chandra was devoted to **Vishnu** and set up the Vishnu dhvaja (Flagpole in honour of Vishnu) as a standard of that God on a hill called Vishnupada. *'Mehrauli Iron Pillar Inscription' acquired from Mehrauli in Delhi is located in the centre of the courtyard of Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque near Qutub Minar at present.

*Gupta ruler Chandragupta-II 'Vikramaditya' was known as the '**Saka Conqueror**' as he admonished Saka power by defeating last Saka king of western India Rudrasimha-III. He adopted the title of 'Sakari' after this victory. He launched silver coins on this occasion. They were called 'Rupaka' in Gupta rule. The Nine Gems of Chandragupta II were (1) **Kalidas** (Poet), (2) **Dhanvantari** (Physician), (3) **Varahamihira** (Astronomer), (4) **Amar Singh** (Lexicographer), (5) **Shanku** (Architect) (6) **Kshapanak** (Astrologer), (7) **Vararuchi** (Grammarians), (8) **Vetala Bhatta** (Magician) (9) **Ghata Karpara** (Diplomat).

***Kumaragupta I 'Mahendraditya'** (415-455 AD) was the son born to Dhruvadevi, wife of Chandragupta II. *The first invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of **Skandagupta** (455-467 AD) and Hunas were comprehensively defeated by him. This invasion was just like a raid without any lasting impact on India, but this invasion hastened the decline of the Gupta Empire. Hunas annexed many regions of the north-west in the transition period of 5th-6th centuries after the death of Skandagupta.

***Bhitari Pillar inscription** is found from a place named **Bhitari** in **Saidpur** tehsil of district **Ghazipur**, Uttar Pradesh. The description of the war between Skandagupta and Hunas is mentioned in Bhitari Pillar inscription. It is noteworthy that the first Indian invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of **Skandagupta** (455-467 AD) in which Hunas were badly defeated by Skandagupta. When the Hunas invasion ended the Roman Empire in 3rd century AD., the Indian merchants relied more and more on the South East Asian trade.

***Toramana** was the leader of the second Hunas attack on India.

***Mihirakula** was a central Asian Hunas origin, who was one of the most important Hephthalite Emperor. The Gwalior inscription showed his territory which included Gwalior. Mihirakula suffered a defeat by the Aulikara king Yasodharman of Malwa in 528 AD. or by some other sources 495 A.D.

*The **Tamralipti port** in Bengal was a prominent port during Gupta period from where trade was conducted with south-east Asia, China, Lanka, Java, Sumatra as well as northern India. Western coast had an important port of **Bhriku Kachchha (Bharuch)** from where Gupta rulers used to trade with western countries. *Guilds were very important in the economy of ancient India. These organizations were established by merchants for the proper regulation of their trade. Guilds had the judicial power of their members and also had the power to ensure the salary, rules of job, standards and prices. Every guild had its head without any intervention by the kingdom. It was also important for governing the local bodies.

*Gujarat, Bengal, Deccan and Tamil Nadu were famous for the production of the garments in the Gupta period. The garment industry was the principal industry of the Gupta period. During the Gupta period, the main centres of international trade were Tamralipti, Bhriku Kachchha, Arikamedu, Kaveripattanam, Muziris, Pratihasthana, Sopara, Barberikam.

***Dhanvantari** was one of the Navratnas of Chandragupta II. He was a master in Ayurveda. Bhaskara I was Gupta contemporary. He wrote Mahabhaskariya & Laghubhaskariya. **Bhaskaracharya** (Bhaskara II) was a great astronomer and mathematician. He composed '**Siddhanta Shiromani**' and '**Lilavati**' based on astronomy and mathematics. He was not a contemporary of Guptas. He belonged to 12th century.

*Development in mathematics is notable in the Gupta period. **Sine**, **Cosine**, and **Inverse sine** were known in 5th Century. These are mentioned in '**Surya Siddhanta**' and '**Aryabhatiya**'. Brahmagupta described cyclic quadrilateral.

We find six types of gold currencies during the reign of Samudragupta. They were Garuda, Archer, Parashu, Ashvamedha, Vaghra-Prakramah, Veena Type. According to the Chinese traveller Fa-Hien, people used clamshells in routine trading activities. Coins of Gupta rulers were found in Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Orissa (Odisha). The most famous place where coins were found in

Bayana (Bharatpur, Rajasthan). Coins issued by them were known as **Rupaka** and the gold currencies were called Dinara.

*The first evidence of '**Sati Practice**' in India is mentioned in the **Eran** inscription. This inscription belongs to **510 AD** in which the practice of Sati was mentioned for a lady who was the wife of a war commander named 'Gopraj'. *During Gupta period, towns declined gradually. All the towns which were prosperous in the valley, most of them had declined in that age. A major city, **Pataliputra** became village when Hiuen-Tsang came to India. Mathura, Sonpur and Sohgauna- all major cities provided evidence of a decline in this age.

*Gupta period in ancient India is considered as the golden age due to the excellent development in the field of art and culture.

*The ruler of Gupta dynasty donated the maximum number of villages to temples and Brahmins. Also, the income generated from the land of the village used to be given to the owner of the land. A person who used to cultivate on the official land of the ruler had to pay a part of crop-products as tax in the Gupta period which was the sixth portion (1/6) of the production.

*Land revenue is known as '**Udrang**' and "**Bhag**" in Gupta inscriptions. *In ancient India, the irrigation tax was known as '**Udakabhog**'. ***Hiranya** was the cash tax in Mauryan period. The land tax was called **Udrang** in Gupta inscriptions. '**Uparnika**' was the tax on farmers living on the border land.

*In Sanskrit plays, written during Gupta period, women and Sudras spoke in Prakrit language while upper varnas (classes) person used Sanskrit to speak. *Except for Vedic age, the situation of women was never good in ancient India. In the age of Gupta, Maurya and Chola, the evidence of inferior situation of women has been found. Thus, situation of women with men cannot be compared in any age. '**Mrichchhakatika**' written by Sudraka tells about the change in society and administration during the Gupta period. This text deals with the love story of Charudatta (Carudatta), a rich merchant with the **Vasantasena**, the daughter of a courtesan.

*The rule of the Gupta Empire was monarchical. Unlike other rulers, the Gupta rulers believed in their divine origin. The Gupta rulers expanded the tradition of donation of land. The nature of the Gupta administration was not centralized and conservative; the Gupta king was the king of many smaller kingdoms. The feudal and provincial rulers experienced absolute independence in their respective areas. *The game of chess originated in India during Gupta period, known as '**Chaturanga**.' It reached Iran and then Europe from India. **Pravarasena I** (275-335 AD) the ruler of **Vakataka dynasty**, was the first Vakataka ruler who called himself a **Samrat**. Vakataka ruler Pravarasena I conducted four Ashvamedha Yajnas. Along with this, he also made many Vedic sacrifices. Emperor Pravarasena II of the same dynasty was interested in literature; he composed a treatise called '**Setubandha**'. *Hindu philosophy refers to a group of darshans (philosophies, worldviews, teachings) that emerged in

ancient India. The mainstream Hindu philosophy includes six systems (Saddarsana) **Sankhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, and Vedanta**.

***Sankhya Darshan** is one of the most ancient philosophical schools of India. **Maharshi Kapila** is known as the 'Acharya' of Sankhya Darshan. He composed '**Sankhya Sutra**' and Tattva samas. *Sankhya philosophy accepts the theory of **rebirth** or **transmigration of the soul**. Nescience is the cause of sorrow and self-enlightenment through knowledge is the solution for liberation from it. Sankhya held that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

***Maharshi Patanjali** is known as the founder of 'Yoga Darshan.' The description of yoga is found in Upanishad, Mahabharat, Bhagavad Geeta, Jain and Buddha texts. Maharshi Patanjali explained it as a compact philosophical theory. So it is called as 'Patanjali Darshan'. **Ashtanga Yoga** means "eight-limbed yoga" as outlined by the sage Patanjali in the Yog Sutras. It consists of eight spiritual practices. Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana and Samadhi. Patanjali was contemporary to Pushyamitra Shunga (184-148 BC).

*'**Nyaya Darshan**' was propagated by **Gautama** who is also known as '**Akshapada**'. The word 'Nyaya' means **decision** or **logics**. Nyaya Darshan recognizes the existence of 16 substances or logics. The original text of Nyaya Darshan is '**Nyayasutra**' which is the masterpiece of Gautama.

*The theory of karma is related to '**Mimamsa**' philosophy. It is also known as Karma Mimamsa, Purva Mimamsa or Dharma Mimamsa. *'**Mimamsa**' philosophy accepts that **Vedas contain the eternal truth**. Purva Mimamsa tells about '**Karmakanda**' while Uttar Mimamsa tells about '**Gyankand**'.

***Vedanta philosophy** is considered to be the culmination of Indian ideology. Vedanta literally means - '**The end of the Vedas**' or 'the climax of Vedic ideology'. Vedanta philosophy has three bases - Upanishads, Brahmasutra and Bhagavad Gita. They are called the 'Prasthanatrayi'.

***Maharshi Kanad** was the founder of **Vaisheshika School** of Indian philosophy. He propounded **atom theory** and is called the founder of Indian Atomism. According to this theory material, subjects are made up of atoms. The Vaisheshika thus marked the beginning of physics in India. Kanad was first to prove that atom is the smallest unit of any matter. Atom cannot be seen through naked eyes and cannot be further divided.

*The Vaisheshika school gives importance to the discussion of material elements or dravya. Earth, Water, Fire, Air and Sky, when combine give rise to new objects.

*According to Puranas, Chandravansh (or Somvansha) was one of the prime dynasties of the Kshatriya varna. The prime place of the Chandravansha's ruler was Prayag but after a natural calamity, Dwapar Yug Chandravanshi king Samvaram established his capital in Pratishthanpur (present Jhansi, Prayagraj). *Agnikula was the most famous **Pratihara dynasty**

of the Rajputs. Due to being related to the branch of Gurjars, it is known as the Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty in history. *The first description of the Gurjara caste is in the Aihole text of Pulakeshin II. Gurjars are mentioned in the Harshacharita of Banabhatta. The founder of the Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty was **Nagabhata I** (730 - 756 AD). The Gwalior inscription shows that he had destroyed the large army of Mlechcha king, which was probably the Arab ruler of Sindh.

***The Rashtrakuta dynasty** was established in 736 AD by **Dantidurga**. He made the **Manyakheta** as his capital. About Dantidurga, it is said that in Ujjaini, he conducted a Hiranyagarbha (Mahadan) Yajna. *Rashtrakuta ruler Amoghavarsha I was born in 800 AD in the military camp of Sribhavan, on the banks of river Narmada. At this time, his father, Rashtrakuta King Govind III was returning after successful campaigns of North India.

Maukhari were the feud of the Guptas, who were originally residents of Gaya. The rulers of the Maukhari dynasty made Kannauj their capital. Hari Varma, Aditya Varma, Ishvara-Varma, Sharva-Varma and Graha-Varma were the main rulers of this dynasty.

*Detailed information regarding Harsha is obtained from **Harshacharita**, which was composed by author **Banabhatta**. Some information regarding him is also available from **Rajatarangini** written by Kalhana. *Chinese sources revealed that **Harsha** and **Rajyashri** ruled together over Kannauj. Harsha shifted his capital to Kannauj from Thaneshwar to help his sister Rajyashri in the proper administration of Kannauj. Harsha held a massive council of various religions and sects in Kannauj. According to the Chinese evidence, rulers of 20 countries along with their eminent Brahmins, shramanas, courtiers, etc. arrived there. This meeting was presided over by **Hiuen Tsang**. A function used to be held at Sangam region of Prayagraj every fifth year of Harsha's rule, which is stated as '**Mahamoksha council**.' Hiuen Tsang himself attended the 6th function which was attended by 18 rulers of various countries.

*Emperor Harsha's southward march was stopped on the Narmada River by **Pulakesin-II**. Pulakesin-II also wanted to expand the state towards the north, in such a situation the war was inevitable between the two. Actually, there was a war between the two, at the bank of the Narmada, in which Pulakesin-II defeated Harsha. This incident is mentioned in **Aihole inscription** of Pulakesin-II and description of Hiuen Tsang. *The arrival of **Hiuen Tsang** was the most important event of Harsha's period. He departed for India in 629 AD from Changan, the capital of Tang ruler. He wrote a book on his tour to India named '**Sei-Yu-Kei**'.

*Hiuen Tsang went to Nalanda University in 637 AD. Acharya Sheelbhadra was the vice-chancellor of Nalanda University at that time. According to Hiuen Tsang, Mathura was famous for the production of cotton textiles at that time, while, Varanasi

was famous for the silk textiles. Hiuen Tsang says that the main reason for the prosperity of Thaneshwar was the trade there. *Kannauj became the center of attraction for various powers after Harsha's death. It has been expressed by the names 'Mahodaya', 'Mahodayashri' etc. There was a triangular struggle between the three great powers of the 8th century- **Pala, Gurjara-Pratihara** and **Rashtrakuta** for the control of Kannauj which is the most important event in the history of North India in the 8th-9th century. In this struggle, ultimately, the Pratiharas got success.

*The Chinese traveller **Itsing** with 37 Buddhist associates decided to travel to western countries in 671 or 672 AD. He came to India through western sea route and returned to China in 693 - 94 AD via Sumatra. In ancient days, Chinese writers mentioned India by the names of '**Yin-tu**' and '**Thian-tu**'. Nalanda University was ransacked and destroyed by the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji in 1193 AD. It was the final blow to Buddhism in India and set it on the path of decline.

***Shankaracharya** is also known as Shankar, Shree Shankaracharya etc. He was born in Kaladi, a small village in Kerala in the 8th century. His philosophy is known as 'Advaita Vedanta'. The religious centres established by him are - (1) **Sringeri** (Karnataka) in south, (2) **Dwarka** (Gujarat) in west, (3) **Puri** (Odisha) - in the east and (4) **Jyotirmath** (Joshimath, Uttarakhand) - in the north. Badrinath, Dwarka, Puri and Rameswaram are Chardham, while Gangotri, Yamunotri, Kedarnath and Badrinath are the Chota (lesser) Dham located in Uttarakhand.

1. Gupta dynasty ruled during :

- (a) 319-500 A.D. (b) 319-324 A.D.
- (c) 325-375 A.D. (d) 566-597 A.D.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

Gupta dynasty ruled during 275-550 AD. This dynasty was established by King Srigupta around 275 AD, but the first powerful ruler of Gupta dynasty was Chandragupta I who ruled during 319-335 AD. He has held the title of 'Maharajadhiraja' (in contradiction to his predecessors) to show his importance. So option (a) is the most accurate answer.

2. Who of the following rulers had performed four Ashwamedhas?

- (a) Pushyamitra Shunga (b) Pravarasena-I
- (c) Samudragupta (d) Chandragupta-II

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

King of Vakataka, Pravarasena-I had performed four Ashwamedhas. He also performed many Vedic oblations. Pravarasena-II, another ruler of the same dynasty, was interested in literature, and wrote 'Setubandha.'

3. Who is known as the Napoleon of India?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Chandragupta- II Vikramaditya
- (c) Great Ashoka
- (d) Samudragupta

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009
Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2005
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

Historian V.A. Smith in his composition 'Early History of India' called Samudragupta (335-375 AD) of Gupta dynasty as 'Napoleon of India' for his great military conquests.

4. Who is called 'the Napoleon of Ancient India'?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Pushyamitra
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Samudragupta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Who among the following Gupta Kings had another name Devagupta ?

- (a) Samudragupta
- (b) Chandragupta- II
- (c) Kumaragupta
- (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

Another name of Gupta ruler Chandragupta-II 'Vikramaditya' is found as Devagupta. Its evidence has been obtained from Sanchi and Vakataka inscriptions. Apart from the above-mentioned names, he is also known as Devaraja and Devashri.

6. The first Gupta ruler to assume the title of "Param Bhagavata" was

- (a) Chandragupta- I
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Chandragupta- II
- (d) Srigupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The copperplate inscription of Samudragupta from Nalanda and Gaya describes param Bhagavata title of Samudragupta. Although UPPSC has given option (c) as correct answer while UGC has accepted Samudragupta as right answer.

7. The first Gupta ruler to assume the title of 'Parama Bhagawat' was

- (a) Chandragupta- I
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Chandragupta- II
- (d) Ramagupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

8. The Allahabad Pillar inscription is associated with which one of the following?

- (a) Mahapadma Nanda
- (b) Chandragupta Maurya
- (c) Ashoka
- (d) Samudragupta

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c & d)

The Ashoka pillar inscription of Allahabad (Prayagraj) is associated with Samudragupta (335-375 AD). It is considered to be the most important historical document of the classical Gupta age, written in excellent Sanskrit written by Harisena. It is also known as 'Prayag Prashasti.' The inscription is a panegyric (tribute) praising Samudragupta and lists the political and military achievements of his reign including his expeditions to the south. Built by Ashoka, originally it was situated in Kaushambi, which was later shifted to Allahabad (Prayagraj) by Akbar. The names of Jahangir and Birbal is also mentioned there.

9. The Ashoka Pillar at Allahabad provides information about the reign of?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Chandragupta- I
- (c) Chandragupta- II
- (d) Samudragupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

10. Prayag Prashasti tells about the military campaign of-

- (a) Chandragupta- I
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Chandragupta- II
- (d) Kumaragupta

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

11. What was the name of the ruler of Kosal in Samudragupta's "Prayag Prashasti"?

- (a) Shiv Gupta
- (b) Someshwar Deo
- (c) Mahendra
- (d) Mahipal
- (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Koshala has been mentioned in the 'Prayag Prashasti' of Samudragupta along with other kingdoms and their kings of 'Dakshinapath'. Mahendra is mentioned as king of Koshala in the inscription.

12. An inscription by which of the following is found on the pillar containing Prayag Prasasti of Samudragupta?

- (a) Jahangir (b) Shahjahan
(c) Aurangzeb (d) Dara Shikoh

U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Prayag Prashasti is the name given to Allahabad pillar. It is an Ashokan Pillar but has four different inscriptions: Ashokan inscription in Brahmi script. Queen edict regarding the charitable deed of Ashoka's wife, Karuvaki. Samudragupta inscription written by Harisena in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script and Jahangir inscription in Persian.

13. Which one of the following Gupta rulers is referred to as 'Lichchhavi-Dauhitra' (Son of the daughter of the Lichchhavis)?

- (a) Chandragupta I (b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta II (d) Skandagupta

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The Gupta ruler Samudragupta was referred to as 'Lichchhavi-Dauhitra' (Grandson of the Lichchhavis). Samudragupta's mother, Kumaradevi, was a princess of the Lichchhavi dynasty, which is why he was given this title. Samudragupta's father was Chandragupta I.

14. 'Prithivya Pratham Veer' was the title of –

- (a) Samudragupta (b) Rajendra-I
(c) Amoghavarsha (d) Gautamiputra Shatkarni

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

In his book "A Political History of the Imperial Guptas", Tej Ram Sharma describes Ashvamedha Yajna which was done by Samudragupta. After this ritual, he assumed the title of 'Prithivya Pratiratha' which means a man who has no rival on the earth (The first brave man on the Earth). Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission excluded this question from the evaluation.

15. Read the following statements:

1. Harisena was the famous poet of Samudragupta's Court.
2. He composed the epic 'Devichandraguptam'.
3. He was also the author of 'Prayagprashasti'.

Select the correct answer :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 are correct (b) 1 and 2 are correct
(c) 2 and 3 are correct (d) 1 and 3 are correct
(e) Only 1 is correct

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2017]

Ans. (d)

Samudra Gupta Court poet and minister Harisena has presented a praiseworthy description in the Sanskrit language on Allahabad Pillar which has been called the Prayag Prashasti. This inscription is an eulogy of Samudragupta and mentions his conquests. 'Devichandraguptam' is a composition of Vishakhadatta. Hence statements 1 and 3 are correct while 2 is incorrect.

16. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below.

List-I (Samudra Gupta's Contemporary Kings of South India)	List-II (Their Kingdoms)
A. Dhananjaya	1. Avamukta
B. Nilaraja	2. Kanchi
C. Ugrasena	3. Kusthalpura
D. Vishnugopa	4. Palaka

- Codes :
- | | | | |
|-------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| (a) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| (d) 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |

[UPPCS (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows:

List-I	List-II
Dhananjaya	– Kusthalpura
Nilaraja	– Avamukta
Ugrasena	– Palaka
Vishnugopa	– Kanchi

17. The iron column, located in the courtyard of Delhi's Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque is retention of –

- (a) Ashok (b) Chandra
(c) Harsha (d) Anangapal

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

Mehrauli Iron Pillar inscription' acquired from Mehrauli in Delhi is located in the center of the courtyard of Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque. It describes a king named "Chandra" who is assumed as Chandragupta II of Gupta clan. According to recognition, the Mehrauli iron pillar was situated at Vishnugiri near Udaigiri Hills during the period of Chandragupta II around 410 AD. Chandragupta II was the devotee of Lord Vishnu. He constructed this iron pillar in respect of Lord Vishnu. Emblem bearer of Lord Vishnu 'Garuda' was engraved on the apex of the pillar.

18. Which Gupta ruler assumed the throne after killing his elder brother?

- (a) Shri Gupta (b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta II (d) Skandagupta
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (c)

After Samudragupta, his son Ramagupta became the ruler, but due to his inability to oppose the invasion of Sakas, his brother Chandragupta II killed Ramagupta and married his wife Dhruv Devi and won against Sakas.

19. Which dynasty was distracted the most by the Hunas invasion?

- (a) Maurya (b) Kushan
(c) Gupta (d) Shunga

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

The first invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of Skandagupta and Hunas were comprehensively defeated by him. This invasion was just like a raid, and there was no lasting impact on India, but this invasion intensified the decline of the Gupta Empire. Hunas annexed many regions of the northwest in the transition period of 5th-6th centuries after the death of Skandagupta.

20. The Hunas invaded India during the reign of :

- (a) Chandragupta-II (b) Kumaragupta-I
(c) Skandagupta (d) Budhagupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

21. Who among the following Gupta rulers conquered Hunas?

- (a) Chandragupta- II (b) Kumaragupta- I
(c) Skandagupta (d) Bhanugupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

22. The Gupta emperor who defeated the 'Hunas' was?

- (a) Samudragupta (b) Chandragupta- II
(c) Skandagupta (d) Ramagupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

23. Who among the following Gupta rulers defeated Hunas?

- (a) Samudragupta (b) Chandragupta- II
(c) Kumaragupta (d) Skandagupta

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

24. From which inscription is it known that Skandagupta defeated Hunas?

- (a) Bhitari Pillar Inscription
(b) Allahabad Pillar Inscription
(c) Mandsaur Inscription
(d) Udayagiri Inscription

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Bhitari Pillar inscription is found at the place known as Bhitari in Saidpur tehsil of district Ghazipur, Uttar Pradesh. The description of the war between Skandagupta and Hunas is mentioned in Bhitari Pillar inscription. It is noteworthy that the first Indian invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of Skandagupta in which Hunas were badly defeated by Skandagupta.

25. There were different causes for the downfall of the Gupta Empire.

Which one among the statements given below was not a cause?

- (a) Huna invasion
(b) Feudal set-up of administration
(c) Acceptance of Buddhism by the later Guptas
(d) Arab invasion

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

The decline of the Gupta Empire was not due to the Arab invasion. Arabs invaded India during the medieval era, much later after the downfall of Gupta dynasty.

26. Who is known as 'Saka-conqueror'?

- (a) Chandragupta- I (b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta- II (d) Kumaragupta

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Gupta Ruler Chandragupta- II 'Vikramaditya' was known as the 'Saka Conqueror' as he eliminated Saka power by defeating last Saka king Rudrasimha- III in the first decade of the 5th century. He adopted the title of 'Sakari' after this victory. He issued silver coins (Rupak) on this occasion.

27. Who was the first Gupta ruler to issue silver coins?

- (a) Chandragupta- I (b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta- II (d) Kumargupta

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

28. With reference to Chandragupta – II, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The strongest evidence in the context of Saka Victory is the silver coins of this King.

2. The weight of these coins used to be about 33 grains.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Only 1
(c) Neither 1 nor 2 (d) Only 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

After victory over Saka, Chandragupta II released silver coins. These coins usually weigh around 30 to 33 grains. Hence both statements are true.

29. After conquering the Shakas, which of the following metal coins were introduced by Chandragupta II?

- (a) Gold (b) Silver
(c) Copper (d) Bronze

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Chandragupta-II's victory over the mighty Sakas dynasty was his foremost success. The annexation of Sakas kingdom comprising Gujarat and part of Malwa strengthened the Gupta Empire, but also brought it into direct touch with western sea ports. After the victory over Sakas, Chandragupta-II adopted the title of 'Sakari' (Destroyer of the Sakas). Chandragupta-II issued dated silver coins to commemorate his victory over Saka Kshatrapas.

30. The famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of :-

- (a) Chandragupta I
(b) Chandragupta II
(c) Ramagupta
(d) Srigupta
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta-II.

31. In which dynasty did Chandragupta II marry his daughter Prabhavati and strengthen his position?

- (a) Lichchhvi Dynasty (b) Kadamb Dynasty
(c) Vakataka Dynasty (d) Naga Dynasty
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Prabhavati was the daughter of Chandragupta II. She married Rudrasen II of the Vakataka dynasty. After her husband's death, she effectively ruled the Vakataka Empire as regent.

32. Prabhavati Gupta was the ruler of

- (a) Gupta Dynasty (b) Sunga Dynasty
(c) Vakataka Dynasty (d) Maukhari Dynasty

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Prabhavati Gupta was the daughter of one of the most important rulers in early Indian history, Chandragupta II. She was married into another important ruling family, that of the Vakatakas, who were powerful in the Deccan. She was the Vakataka queen, who was the consort of Maharaja Rudrasena II. Following the death of her husband, she effectively ruled the Vakataka kingdom as regent.

33. Consider the following about the King "Pravarasena" :

- (A) He was the real founder of Vakataka dynasty.
(B) His empire extended from Bundelkhand in north to Hyderabad in South.
(C) He succeeded his father King Vindhya-shakti.
(D) He is mentioned in Puranas.

Which of the following statements is correct ?

- (a) (A) and (B) both
(b) (A) and (C) both
(c) (B), (C) and (D)
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The Vakataka dynasty was an ancient Indian royal dynasty that ruled over the central and southern parts of India from the 3rd century CE to the end of the 5th century and the beginning of the 6th century CE. The founder of this dynasty was Vindhya-shakti, whose successor was Pravarasena I, who is also considered the actual founder of the Vakataka dynasty. During the time of Pravarasena I, the boundaries of the Vakataka dynasty reached from Bundelkhand in north to Deccan (including modern Hyderabad) in the south. The Vakataka rulers expanded their territory to include vast regions under their influence. Among the rulers of the Vakataka dynasty, Pravarasena I assumed the title of Samrat (Emperor) and performed several Ashvamedha Yajnas (horse sacrifices) and Vedic rituals. According to the Puranas, he is referred to as Pravira. Thus, all the given statements are correct.

34. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Kumargupta I : Mandsaur inscription
(b) Patik : Takshashila inscription
(c) Prabhavati Gupta : Udayagiri cave inscription
(d) Samudragupta : Eran inscription

[U.P.P.C.S. (Mains)-2017]

Ans. (c)

The correct matching is as follows—

Kumargupta I	: Mandsaur inscription
Patik	: Takshashila inscription
Chandragupt II	: Udayagiri cave inscription
Samudragupta	: Eran inscription

No records of Prabhavati Gupta have been obtained from the Udayagiri Cave inscription.

35. Which of the following inscriptions is known as the first advertisement of the World?

- (a) Dashpur inscription (b) Sohgara inscription
(c) Supia inscription (d) Eran inscription

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Dashpur inscription is the first advertisement of the world. Also known as Mandsaur inscription, it belongs to the period of Kumargupta-I and contains advertisements about silk trade.

36. Mandsaur – Prashasti presents the details of the achievements of which ruler?

- (a) Skandagupta (b) Chandragupta-II
(c) Ramagupta (d) Kumaragupta-I

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (d)

Vatsabhatta or Vatsabhathi was a contemporary of Kumargupta-I, composed the Mandsaur-Prashasti at Malwa. The Mandsaur-Prashasti presents the details of achievements of Kumargupta-I. It also describes that the silk workers had constructed a sun temple here which was repaired by Bandhuvarma.

37. Which of the following inscription reveals information about Silk Weavers Guild?

- (a) Dashpur Inscription (b) Prayag Prashasti
(c) Eran Inscription (d) Hathigumpha Inscription

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Dashpur (Mandsaur) inscription of Kumargupta I mentions Tantuwayas (silk waver guild) and also mentions his governor Bndhuvarman and the erection of the sun temple. It was during his reign, a temple dedicated to Surya was constructed by the silk-weavers at Dashpur. The temple was renovated by the same guild.

38. In relation to the Dashpur inscription of Kumaragupta and Bandhuvarman, which statement is incorrect?

- (a) The inscription mentions the construction of the Sun Temple by the guild of silk weavers.
(b) It is oldest example of the advertisement tradition in Bharat.
(c) The inscription also refers to Dashpur as Pashchimapur.
(d) The inscription was composed by Bhavabhuti.

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

In the Dashpur (Mandsaur) inscription of Kumaragupta and Bandhuvarman, it is mentioned that the Sun Temple in Dashpur was constructed by the guild of silk weavers from the Lata region (Gujarat). It describes silk fabrics, which are considered oldest example of the advertisement tradition in India. The inscription also refers to Dashpur as Pashchimapur. The inscription was not composed by Bhavabhuti but rather by Vatsabhathi.

39. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List-I (Kings)	List-II (Queens)
A. Chandragupta	1. Duttadevi
B. Samudragupta	2. Kubernaga
C. Chandragupta II	3. Kumaradevi
D. Kumargupta I	4. Anantdevi

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 3	1	2	4
(b) 2	1	3	4
(c) 1	2	3	4
(d) 4	3	2	1

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Correct match is as follows –

Chandragupta	– Kumaradevi
Samudragupta	– Duttadevi
Chandragupta-II	– Kubernaga
Kumargupta-I	– Anantdevi

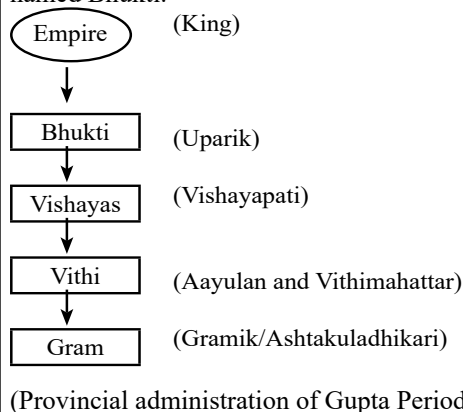
40. Which one of the following is the correct sequence of administrative division during the Gupta Period?

- (a) Bhukti → Vishaya → Vithi → Grama
(b) Vishaya → Bhukti → Vithi → Grama
(c) Vithi → Bhukti → Vishaya → Grama
(d) None of the above

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

During Gupta period, the empire was divided into provinces named Bhukti.



41. From the third century AD when the Huna invasion ended the Roman Empire, the Indian merchants relied more and more on the :

- (a) African trade
- (b) Western-European trade
- (c) South-East Asian trade
- (d) Middle-Eastern trade

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

When the Huna invasion ended the Roman empire in 3rd century A.D. the Indian merchants relied more and more on the South East Asian trade.

42. Which one of the following ports handled the North Indian trade during the Gupta period ?

- (a) Tamralipti
- (b) Bhadoch
- (c) Kalyan
- (d) Cambay

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1999
U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014**

Ans. (a)

The Tamralipti port in Bengal was a prominent port during the Gupta period from where trade was conducted with South-East Asia, China, Lanka, Java, Sumatra as well as northern India. Western coast had an important port of Bhriku Kachhha (Bharuch) from where Gupta rulers used to trade with western countries.

43. Which one of the following ports was in use for the North Indian trade during the Gupta period?

- (a) Kalyan
- (b) Tamralipti
- (c) Broach
- (d) Cambay
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

During the Gupta period, Tamralipti of Bengal was an important port that was used for trading with South-East Asia, China, Lanka, Java, Sumatra etc. Bhriukatchha (Bharuch) was an important port of western India from where trade of North India with western countries occurred through sea-routes. During the Gupta period, most of the Indian trade happened with South-East Asia, hence Tamralipti was most important port of this period. However, Bharuch, Kalyan, Cambay etc. were also used for North Indian trade. Hence most suitable answer would be more than one which is option (e).

44. India maintained its early cultural contacts and trade links with South-East Asia across the Bay of Bengal. For this pre-eminence of the early maritime history of Bay of Bengal, which of the following could be the most convincing explanation/explanations?

- (a) As compared to other countries, India had a better shipbuilding technology in ancient and medieval times
- (b) The rulers of Southern India always patronized traders, brahmin priests and Buddhist monks in this context

- (c) Monsoon winds across the Bay of Bengal facilitated sea voyages
- (d) Both (a) and (b) are convincing explanations in this context

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

India maintained its early cultural contacts and trade links with South East Asia across the Bay of Bengal, as the monsoon winds originating from the Bay of Bengal facilitated the cruise, which in turn enhanced trade and cultural contacts. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

45. With reference to the guilds (Shreni) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the state, and the King was the chief administrative authority on them.
 - 2. The wages, rules of work, standards and prices were fixed by the guild.
 - 3. The guild had judicial powers over its members.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below:**
- (a) 1 and 2 only
 - (b) 3 only
 - (c) 2 and 3 only
 - (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Guilds were very important in the economy of ancient India. These organizations were established by merchants for the proper regulation of their trade. Guilds had the judicial power over their members and also had the power to ensure the salaries, rules of job, standards and prices. Every guild had its head without any intervention by the kingdom. It was also important for governing the local bodies.

46. Centers located in Gujarat, Bengal, Deccan and Tamil Country during the Gupta period were associated with which of the following:

- (a) Textile manufacture
- (b) Gems and precious stones
- (c) Handicrafts
- (d) Opium cultivation

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Gujarat, Bengal, Deccan and Tamil Nadu were famous for the textile manufacturing industry. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer. The textile industry was a prime industry during the Gupta period.

47. In ancient period, which Varna was also called as 'Sarthavaha'?

- (a) Brahmana
- (b) Kshatriya
- (c) Vaishya
- (d) Shudra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2017

Proper rules of conduct for trade were prescribed by the head of trade guilds, known as Sarthavaha or Srenipramukh. The rules were called Samay and Srenidharma. Hence, the term Sarthavaha is associated with the Vaishya.

48. Who among the following is known for his work on medicine during the Gupta period?

- (a) Sushruta (b) Saumilla
(c) Shudraka (d) Shaunaka
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

Sushruta is called the father of surgery. He was a resident of Kashi. It is believed that his period was around 600 BC. Shaunaka was a sage of the Rigveda. Shudraka was a dramatist of the Gupta period (litterateur). Saumilla is a playwright of Gupta period who has been remembered by Kalidasa with language and poetry. Thus, none of the above had worked in the field of medicine during the Gupta period. Although Bihar Public Service Commission, in its initial answer sheet, has considered the correct answer as option (a). Since the Gupta period begins in 275 AD (Sri Gupta), which is about 875 years later than the valid period of Sushruta (usually 600 BC), it is not reasonable to consider Sushruta a contemporary of the Gupta period.

49. Who among the following is known for his Ayurvedic thematic composition during Gupta period?

- (a) Saumilla (b) Shudraka
(c) Shunaka (d) Sushruta

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (*)

See the explanation of above question.

50. Who among the following is not associated with medicine in ancient India?

- (a) Dhanvantari (b) Bhaskaracharya
(c) Charaka (d) Sushruta

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Dhanvantari was one of the Navratnas of Chandragupta II. He was a master in Ayurveda. Charaka and Sushruta were also great scholars of Ayurveda. Charaka was the physician of Kanishka who wrote 'Charaka Samhita' while Bhaskaracharya was a great astronomer and mathematician. He composed 'Siddhanta Shiromani' and 'Lilavati' based on astronomy and mathematics.

51. 'Lilavati' was written by :

- (a) Mahaviracharya (b) Hemchandraacharya
(c) Bhaskaracharya (d) Kalkacharya

Ans. (c)

Bhaskaracharya (Bhaskara-II) wrote Lilavati.

52. With reference to the scientific progress of ancient India, which of the statements given below are correct?

1. Different kinds of specialized surgical instruments were in common use by AD first century.
2. Transplant of internal organs in the human body had begun by the beginning of AD third century.
3. The concept of the sine of an angle was known in AD fifth century.
4. The concept of cyclic quadrilaterals was known in AD seventh century.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The ancient age is notable for scientific developments. Many surgical instruments were used in 1st century A.D., but the transplant of human internal organs was not possible until then. Development in maths is notable in the Gupta period. Sine, Cosine, and inverse Sine were known in 5th century A.D. These are mentioned in 'Surya Siddhanta' and 'Aryabhatiya.' Brahmagupta described cyclic quadrilaterals in 700 A.D. Thus, statements 1, 3 and 4 are correct.

53. In his travels through India, Fahhien has mentioned a hospital, it was located at

- (a) Ujjain (b) Kaushambi
(c) Tamralipti (d) Pataliputra

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Fa Hien has mentioned a hospital at Pataliputra (capital) which was endowed by benevolent citizens. The poor and helpless patients suffering from any kind of disease were taken care of and doctors attended them and they were given food and medicine as per their wants.

54. Who of the following among the Nine Gems of Chandragupta was associated with astrology ?

- (a) Vararuchi (h) Sanku
(c) Kshapanak (d) Amar Singh

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Nine Gems of Chandragupta II were (1) Kalidasa (Poet), (2) Dhanvantari (Physician), (3) Varahamihira (Astronomer), (4) Amar Singh (Lexicographer), (5) Shanku (Architect) (6) Kshapanak (Astrologer), (7) Vararuchi (Grammarians), (8) Vetala Bhatta (Magician), and (9) Ghata Karpara (Diplomat).

55. Kalidasa was in the ruling period of –

- (a) Samudragupta (b) Ashoka
(c) Chandragupta- I (d) Chandragupta- II

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

56. Who among the following was the first to explain that the rotation of the earth on its own axis accounts for the daily rising and setting of the sun?

- (a) Aryabhatta
(b) Bhaskara
(c) Brahmagupta
(d) Varahamihira
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above.

[64th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (a)

Aryabhatta, a mathematician and astronomer, wrote 'Aryabhatiyam'. He stated that day and night were caused by the rotation of the earth on its axis.

57. Which (among these) are Gupta's gold coins?

- (a) Kaudi (b) Dinara
(c) Nishka (d) Pan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

Gold coins issued by Gupta rulers were known as Dinar. According to Fa Hien, people used Dinar for daily business.

58. Gupta gold coin was called -

- (a) Karshapana (b) Dinara
(c) Nishka (d) Suvarna

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

59. The silver coins issued by the Guptas were called :

- (a) Karshapana (b) Dinara
(c) Rupaka (d) Nisc

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

The silver coins issued by the Gupta ruler were known as "Rupaka". The Gupta coins have been found in Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Odisha. Bharatpur (Bayana) in Rajasthan is the place from where a maximum number of coins have been found.

60. Who of the following was the first Gupta ruler to issue coins?

- (a) Chandragupta-I (b) Ghatotkacha
(c) Samudragupta (d) Srugupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Chandragupta-I was the first Gupta ruler who issued the coins. There is no evidence available for issuance of coins by Ghatotkacha and Srugupta, the early rulers of Gupta dynasty. Samudragupta also issued various types of coins, but his tenure was after Chandragupta-I.

61. In Sanskrit plays written during the Gupta period, women and Sudras speak:

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Pali (d) Sauraseni

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

In Sanskrit plays written during Gupta period, women and Sudras spoke in Prakrit language, while upper varnas (classes) person used Sanskrit to speak.

62. The first inscriptional evidence of the Satipratha has been found from –

- (a) Eran (b) Junagarh
(c) Mandasaur (d) Sanchi

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

The first evidence of 'Satipratha' has been found from the inscription of Eran. This inscription belongs to 510 AD in which practice of Sati has been mentioned for a lady who was the wife of a war commander named 'Gopraj.'

63. Who established Gupta Samvat?

- (a) Chandragupta- I (b) Srugupta
(c) Chandragupta- II (d) Ghatotkach

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

Gupta Samvat was started by Chandragupta-I in 319 AD.

64. Match List-I with the List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

List - I (Emperor)	List - II (Titles)
A. Ashoka	1. Parakramank
B. Samudragupta	2. Priyadarsin
C. Chandragupta-II	3. Kramaditya
D. Skandgupta	4. Vikramaditya

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	3	2	1	4
(c)	2	1	4	3
(d)	4	3	2	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

Ashoka	-	Priyadarsin
Samudragupta	-	Parakramanka
Chandragupta-II	-	Vikramaditya
Skandgupta	-	Kramaditya

65. The gradual decline of towns was an important feature of which period?

- (a) Gupta period (b) Pratihara era
(c) Rashtrakut (d) Satavahana era

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

During the Gupta period, towns declined gradually. Most of the towns that were prosperous in the valley, declined in that age. A major city, Pataliputra became a village when Hiuen-Tsang came to India. Mathura, Sonpur, and Sohgaure - all major cities provided evidence of a decline in this age. So, we can say that the gradual decline of towns is an important feature of the Gupta period.

66. Which ruling dynasty donated maximum villages to temples and Brahmins?

- (a) Gupta Dynasty (b) Pala Dynasty
(c) Rashtrakuta (d) Pratihara

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The rulers of the Gupta dynasty donated a maximum number of villages to temples and Brahmins. Also, the income generated from the land of the village used to be given to the owner of the land.

67. In Ancient India, which dynasty's rule is considered as the Golden Age?

- (a) Mauryan (b) Shunga
(c) Gupta (d) Magadha

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Gupta period in ancient India is considered as the Golden Age due to the excellent development in the field of art and culture.

68. During which age, did women enjoy equality with men?

- (a) Gupta age (b) Mauryan age
(c) Cholas (d) None of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Except for the Vedic age, the situation of women was never good in ancient India. In the age of Gupta, Maurya and Chola, the evidence of inferior condition of women has been found. Thus condition of women with men cannot be compared in any age.

69. What was the land revenue rate in Gupta age?

- (a) Fourth part of the production
(b) Sixth part of the production
(c) Eighth part of the production
(d) Half part of the production

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

A person who used to cultivate on the official land of the ruler they had to pay a part of crop-products as tax in Gupta period which was the sixth portion of the production. Land revenue is known as 'Udrang' and 'Bhag' in Gupta inscriptions.

70. What is the land revenue rate in religious books?

- (a) 1/3 (b) 1/4
(c) 1/6 (d) 1/8

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

In every religious text, the land revenue rate is 1/6th of the produce.

71. What is the valid tax according to Hindu law?

- (a) Half of the yields
(b) One-sixth of the yields
(c) One-third of the yields
(d) One-fourth of the yields

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

72. Which type of land was called 'Aprahat'?

- (a) Without cultivated forest land.
(b) Irrigated land.
(c) Dense forest land.
(d) Cultivated land.
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Uncultivable lands were called 'Aprahat'. It was a term of the revenue system in the Gupta period.

73. With reference to the history of India, the terms "kulyavapa" and "dronavapa" denote

- (a) measurement of land
(b) coins of different monetary value
(c) classification of urban land
(d) religious rituals

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Kulyavapa & dronavapa were different measurements of land during the Gupta period.

74. The Gupta Empire granted tax-free agrarian land to which of the following?

- (a) Military officials (b) Civil officials
(c) Brahmins (d) Court scholars

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The Gupta Empire granted tax-free agrarian land to religious functionaries, i.e. Brahmins.

75. In ancient India, the irrigation tax was called –

- (a) Bidakabhagam (b) Hiranya
(c) Udranga (d) Uparnika

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (*)

In ancient India, the irrigation tax was known as 'Udakbhog.' Hiranya was the cash tax in the Mauryan period. The land tax was called Udrang in Gupta inscriptions. 'Uparnika' was the tax on farmers living on the land.

76. In 3rd AD, Warangal was famous for–

- (a) Copper pots (b) Gold Jewelleries
(c) Iron implements (d) Elephant-teeth work

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Warangal was famous for production of iron equipment. 'Agaria' people lived there, and iron making was their traditional occupation.

77. With reference to the period of Gupta dynasty in ancient India, the towns Ghantasala, Kadura and Chaul were well known as

- (a) ports handling foreign trade
(b) capitals of powerful kingdoms
(c) places of exquisite stone art and architecture
(d) important Buddhist pilgrimage centers

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

During Gupta period there was flourishing external and internal trade. Ghantasala, Kadura and Chaul were ports handling foreign trade.

78. Tormana was from the racial group of –

- (a) Sithian (b) Huna
(c) Yaochi (d) Saka

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Toramana was the leader of the second Huna invasion on India.

79. Who amongst the following had defeated Huna ruler Mihirakula?

- (a) Budhagupta (b) Yashodharman
(c) Shashanka (d) Prabhakaravardhana
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Mihirakula was of central Asian Huna origin who was one of the most important Hephthalite emperors. The Gwalior inscription showed his territory which included Gwalior. Mihirakula suffered a defeat by the Aulikara king Yashodharman of Malwa in 528 A.D. (other sources mention 495 A.D.)

80. The Chinese pilgrim who visited India in the early 6th century was –

- (a) Ywan Chwang (b) Fahien
(c) Sungyun (d) I-tsing

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Chinese pilgrim Sungyun came to India in 518 AD and collected texts of Buddha's preaching during his three years of stay in India.

81. Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' came to India in:

- (a) 515 AD to 520 AD
(b) 525 AD to 529 AD
(c) 545 AD to 552 AD
(d) 592 AD to 597 AD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' travelled to India from 518 to 521 AD. He collected texts of Buddha's preaching in his three years of travel.

82. According to Chinese source, Meghavarman, the ruler of Sri Lanka, sent a missionary to which of the following Gupta Kings for permission to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya?

- (a) Chandragupta I (b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta II (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Meghavarman sent a missionary to Samudragupta to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya. Samudragupta granted permission to Buddhist king of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) Meghavarman to build a monastery at Bodh Gaya.

83. Read the following statements carefully–

- Gupta Emperors claimed divine rights for themselves
- Their administration was highly centralized
- They extended the tradition of land grants.

Answer on the basis of the following codes :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 are true (b) 1 and 2 are true
(c) 1 and 3 are true (d) 2 and 3 are true

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

There was a monarchy in the Gupta Empire. They believed in their supernatural origin (opposite to Mauryas). They extended the tradition of land donation. Though it was not centralised, a federal system was followed. So, options 1 and 3 are correct.

84. With reference to forced labour (Vishti) in India during the Gupta period, which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) It was considered a source of income for the state, a sort of tax paid by the people
- (b) It was totally absent in the Madhya Pradesh and Kathiawar regions of the Gupta Empire
- (c) The forced labourer was entitled to weekly wages.
- (d) The eldest son of the labourer was sent as the forced labourer.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Vishti was a form of forced labour enforced by either state, provincial governor or local chief. It is also mentioned in Gupta copper inscriptions that list out a variety of taxes. Junagadh inscription mentions Vishti as one form of tax, which indicates that it was imposed in Gujarat and Malwa regions. Since it was forced labour in lieu of tax, it was not wage labour. Wage labour existed in ancient India, but it was not called Vishti. Vishti could be imposed on anyone, not in particular on eldest son only.

85. The game of 'Chess' is said to have originated in –

- (a) China
- (b) Iran
- (c) Indonesia
- (d) India

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The game of chess originated in India during the Gupta period was known as 'Chaturanga.' It reached Iran and then Europe from India.

86. 'Mrichchhakatika' an ancient Indian book written by Shudraka deals with :

- (a) The love affair of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan
- (b) The victory of Chandragupta II over the Saka Kshatrapas of western India
- (c) The military expeditions and exploits of Samudragupta
- (d) The love affairs between a Gupta King and a princess of Kamarupa

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

'Mrichchhakatika' or "The Little clay cart" written by Sudraka deals with the love story of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan. It also tells about the changes in the society during the Gupta period. It also provides information about some Shudra officers in Ujjayini.

87. Whose contribution is there in ancient Sankhya Darshan?

- (a) Kapila
- (b) Gautam
- (c) Nagarjuna
- (d) Charvak

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Sankhya Darshan is one of the most ancient philosophical schools of India. Maharshi Kapila is known as the 'Acharya' of Sankhya Darshan. He composed 'Sankhya Sutra' and Tatvasamas.

88. The system of philosophy propounded by Kapila Muni is :

- (a) Purva Mimamsa
- (b) Sankhya Philosophy
- (c) Nyaya Philosophy
- (d) Uttar Mimamsa

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

89. 'Sankhya' Philosophy is propounded by –

- (a) Gautam
- (b) Jaimini
- (c) Kapila
- (d) Patanjali

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

90. With reference to the history of philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Sankhya School

- 1. Sankhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of the soul.
- 2. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The Sankhya School is a part of six orthodox schools of Indian philosophy. Sankhya philosophy accepts the theory of rebirth or transmigration of the soul. Nescience is the cause of sorrow and self-enlightenment by knowledge is the solution for liberation from it. Sankhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent. Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

91. Read the following statements and choose the correct option:

Statement I : Kapila is the earliest exponent of Sankhya system

Statement II : Kapila teaches that a man's life is shaped by the forces of nature and not by any divine agency

- (a) Statement I and Statement II both are true

- (b) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true
 (c) Statement I and Statement II both are false
 (d) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Kapila Muni is earliest exponent of Sankhya philosophy. As per the philosophy, man's life is shaped by the forces of nature and not by any divine entity.

92. 'Satkaryavada' is the main doctrine of which philosophical system?

- (a) Vaisheshika philosophy
 (b) Mimamsa philosophy
 (c) Samkhya philosophy
 (d) Nyaya philosophy

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (c)

In the context of cause and effect, the doctrine of Satkaryavada belongs to the Sankhya philosophy. According to Sankhya Darshan, there is an inseparable relationship between cause and effect, meaning that the effect pre-exists in the cause and is manifested from it. The absence of a cause leads to the non-existence of its effect. This type of relationship between cause and effect is called an inseparable connection (Avinabhava), meaning that the existence of one necessarily implies the existence of the other. If one does not exist, the other cannot exist either. The existence of one entity is always dependent on the existence of another. For example, if there is no clay, a pot cannot be created.

93. Who propagated 'Yoga Darshan'?

- (a) Patanjali (b) Gautam
 (c) Jaimini (d) Shankaracharya

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2003

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Maharshi Patanjali is known as the founder of 'Yoga Darshan.' Although the history of Yoga in Indian tradition is very old. The descriptions about Yoga are found in Upanishad, Mahabharat, Bhagavad Gita, Jain and Buddha texts. However, Maharshi Patanjali explained it as a compact philosophical theory. So it is called as 'Patanjali Darshan'.

94. The inventor of Yoga was –

- (a) Aryabhatta (b) Charaka
 (c) Patanjali (d) Ramdeva

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

95. Which one of the following is not part of "Ashtanga-yoga"?

- (a) Anusmriti (b) Pratyahara
 (c) Dhyana (d) Dharana
 (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Ashtanga Yoga means "eight-limbed yoga" as outlined by the sage Patanjali in the Yoga Sutras. It consists of eight spiritual practices. Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana and Samadhi but Anusmriti is not part of Ashtanga-Yoga.

96. What is called Antaranga Sadhana under Ashtanga Yoga?

- (a) Pratyahara (b) Niyama
 (c) Pranayama (d) Dharana

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Ashtanga Yoga, as outlined in Patanjali's Yoga Sutras, provides a comprehensive guide comprising eight limbs. It is designed for the physical, mental, and spiritual development of an individual. These eight limbs are:

1. Yama (Social Discipline)
2. Niyama (Personal Discipline)
3. Asana (Physical Postures)
4. Pranayama (Breath Control)
5. Pratyahara (Withdrawal of Senses)
6. Dharana (Concentration)
7. Dhyana (Meditation)
8. Samadhi (Spiritual Absorption)

In Ashtanga Yoga, the Antaranga Sadhana is the last three limbs of the eight-limbed path of Yoga, and they are considered internal aids to self-realization. These three limbs are Dharana (concentration), Dhyana (meditation) and Samadhi (spiritual absorption).

97. The writer of Mahabhashya 'Patanjali' was contemporary of–

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Ashoka
 (c) Pushyamitra Shunga (d) Chandragupta I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Patanjali (the author of Mahabhashya) was contemporary to Pushyamitra Shunga (184-148 BC).

98. The founder of school of Navya-Nyaya was:

- (a) Raghunath Shiromani (b) Gangesh
 (c) Sridhara (d) Udayana

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b & d)

The foundation of Navya-Nyaya school was the result of the revolutionary work of Mithila based scholar Udayana or Udayanacharya and after that Gangesh.

99. "Live well, as long as you live. Live well even by borrowing, for once cremated, there is no return." This rejection of afterlife is an aphorism of the:

- (a) Kapalika Sects
- (b) Sunyavada of Nagarjuna
- (c) Ajivikas
- (d) Charvakas

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Charvakas emphasised materialistic ideology in the school of Indian philosophy. The idea of this school of philosophy is to live well as long as you live. "Live well even by borrowing, for, once cremated, there is no return".

100. Who has said that "The conscious body is the soul"?

- (a) Nagarjuna
- (b) Charvaka
- (c) Mimamsa
- (d) Asanga

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The Charvaka philosophy considers the physical body as the basis of consciousness. According to Charvaka, the soul and body are synonymous. They stated:

"A body without consciousness is a corpse, and consciousness without a body is not a soul."

They believed that the soul does not exist independently of the body. According to them, the soul is not a separate entity from the body because consciousness arises from the physical body itself. This view of Charvaka is known as 'Dehatmavada' (Materialistic View of the Soul).

101. Who accepts only Perception?

- (a) Jaina
- (b) Charvaka
- (c) Bauddha
- (d) Samkhya

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2018

Ans. (b)

Philosophy of Charvaka, originally known as Lokayata, is the ancient school of Indian materialism. Charvaka holds direct perception, empiricism and conditional inference as a proper source of knowledge, embraces philosophical scepticism and rejects Vedas, Vedic ritualism and supernaturalism.

102. Which one of the following is highest value according to Charvaka?

- (a) Dharma
- (b) Artha
- (c) Kama
- (d) Moksha
- (e) Bhakti

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Charvaka, originally known as Lokayata, is the ancient school of Indian materialism. Charvaka holds direct perception, empiricism and conditional inference as proper sources of knowledge, embraces philosophical scepticism and rejects Vedas, Vedic ritualism and supernaturalism. Ajita Kesakambali is credited as the forerunner of the Charvakas. Charvaka believed that there is nothing wrong with sensual pleasure since it is impossible to have pleasure without pain, Charvaka thought that wisdom lay in enjoying pleasure and avoiding pain as far as possible. Unlike many of the philosophies of the time, Charvaka did not believe in austerities or rejecting pleasure out of fear of pain and held such reasoning to be foolish. The Sarvasiddhanta Samgraha states the Charvaka position on pleasure and hedonism as follows - "The enjoyment of heaven lies in eating delicious food keeping good company of young women, using fine clothes, perfumes, garlands sandal paste..... while Moksha is death which is cessation of life breath..... the wise therefore ought not to take pains on account of Moksha."

103. Charvaka philosophical system was also called :

- (a) Vaishesika system
- (b) Lokayata system
- (c) Astika system
- (d) Mimamsa system

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

104. The Nyaya Philosophical system was propagated by:

- (a) Charvaka
- (b) Gautama
- (c) Kapila
- (d) Jaimini

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

'Nyaya Darshan' was propagated by Gautama who is also known as 'Akshapada.' The word 'Nyaya' means decision or logic. Nyaya Darshan recognizes the existence of 16 substances or elements. The original text of Nyaya Darshan is 'Nyayasutra' which is the masterpiece of Gautama. Maharshi Kapila propagated "Sankhya Darshan" while Jaimini propagated 'Poorva Mimamsa.'

105. The founder of Nyaya Philosophy was

- (a) Kapil
- (b) Kanad
- (c) Gautam
- (d) Jaimini

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

106. Who is the propounder of Nyaya Philosophy?

- (a) Gautam
- (b) Kapil
- (c) Shamkara
- (d) Vallabha

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

107. Author of 'Nyaya Darshan' was-

- (a) Gautama (b) Kapila
(c) Kanad (d) Jaimini

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

108. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Philosophy)	List-II (Methods of achieve salvation)
A. Nyaya Darshan	1. Acquisition of real knowledge
B. Mimamsa Darshan	2. Knowledge of self
C. Sankhya Darshan	3. Performing Vedic rituals
D. Vedanta Darshan	4. Logical thinking

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 2	4	1	3
(b) 4	3	1	2
(c) 1	4	2	3
(d) 3	4	1	2

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Following are the matches :-

List-I (Philosophy)	List-II (Methods to achieve Salvation)
Nyaya Darshan	Logical thinking
Mimamsa Darshan	Performing Vedic rituals
Sankhya Darshan	Acquisition of real knowledge
Vedanta Darshan	Knowledge of self
Philosophy - Propagator	
Nyaya - Gautam	
Purva Mimamsa Darshan - Jaimini	
Sankhya Darshan - Kapil	
Vedanta Darshan/ Uttar Mimamsa - Badarayana	
Veisheshika Darshan - Ulook kanad	
Yoga Darshan - Patanjali	

109. In Nyaya philosophy, which of the following is a synonym for knowledge (Gyana)?

- (a) Buddhi (Cognition)
(b) Upalabdh (Apprehension)
(c) Both (a) and (b)
(d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

In Nyaya philosophy, knowledge (Gyana) is considered synonymous with Buddhi (Cognition) and Upalabdh (Apprehension).

The term Gyana is used in two senses:

- Restricted sense: Refers to unmanifested knowledge.
- Broad sense: Refers to both manifested and unmanifested knowledge.

It is important to note that in Indian philosophy, the means of acquiring knowledge is termed 'Pramana' (valid means of knowledge).

110. Which of the following pairs (School of Thought-Proponent) is correctly matched?

- (a) Vaisheshika – Patanjali
(b) Nyaya – Gautama
(c) Mimamsa – Kanada
(d) Uttara Mimamsa – Kapila

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

The correct match is follows at –

Vaisheshika	–	Kanada Muni
Nyaya	–	Gautam
Purva Mimamsa	–	Jaimini
Uttar Mimamsa	–	Badarayana

111. Mimamsa was initiated by–

- (a) Kanad (b) Vasistha
(c) Vishwamitra (d) Jaimini

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

112. The theory of Karma is related with :

- (a) Nyaya (b) Mimamsa
(c) Vedanta (d) Vaisheshika

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The theory of Karma is related to 'Mimamsa' philosophy. It is also known as Karma Mimamsa, Purva Mimamsa or Dharma Mimamsa. The acharya of Mimamsa, Kumaril Bhatta is considered as the link between Purva Mimamsa and Vedanta.

113. Which of the following schools of philosophy is of the opinion that Vedas contain the eternal truth?

- (a) Sankhya (b) Vaisheshika
(c) Mimamsa (d) Nyaya
(e) Yoga

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

'Mimamsa' philosophy accepts that Vedas contain the eternal truth. Purva Mimamsa tells about 'Karmakanda' while Uttar Mimamsa tells about 'Gyankand.'

114. The doctrine of Apurva is related to

- (a) Charvaka (b) Jaina
(c) Bauddha (d) Mimamsa

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

The doctrine of Apurva/Apoorv is related to Mimamsa philosophy. As per Mimamsa, Apurva is an unseen force that is a mediator between deeds performance (Karma) and their result. The deeds performed in this world create an unseen force known as Apurva i.e something that was not there before the performance of deeds.

115. Which of the following philosophies of India propounded the atom theory?

- (a) Yoga (b) Nyaya
(c) Sankhya (d) Vaisheshika
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (d)

Maharishi Kanada is associated with atom theory. He was scientist & philosopher who founded Vaisheshika school of Indian philosophy in which he gave the atomistic approach to physics and philosophy in Sanskrit.

116. Who among the following is called the founder of Indian Atomism?

- (a) Maharshi Kapil (b) Maharshi Goutam
(c) Maharshi Kanad (d) Maharshi Patanjali
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Maharshi Kanad was the founder of Vaisheshika School of Indian philosophy. He propounded atom theory and called as the founder of Indian Atomism. According to this theory, material subjects are made up of atoms. The Vaisheshika thus marked the beginning of physics in India. Kanad was first to prove that atom is the smallest unit of any matter. Atom cannot be seen through naked eyes and cannot be further divided. The Vaisheshika school gives importance to the discussion of material elements or dravya. Earth, water, fire, air and sky when combined give rise to new objects.

117. Which one of the following pairs does not form part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy?

- (a) Mimamsa and Vedanta
(b) Nyaya and Vaisheshika
(c) Lokayata and Kapalika
(d) Sankhya and Yoga

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

Hindu philosophy refers to a group of darshans (philosophies, worldview, teachings) that emerged in ancient India. The mainstream Hindu philosophy includes six systems (Saddarsana) Sankhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, and Vedanta. Hence Lokayata and Kapalika are not part of the six systems of Indian Philosophy.

118. Which of the following is the Nastika school of thought?

- (a) Sankhya (b) Yoga
(c) Nayaya (d) Bauddha

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Bauddha is considered a Nastika school as they don't take the Vedas as valid source of knowledge. Buddhism has a massive impact on Indian philosophy and culture. Due to the constant dialogue and debate between these non-Vedic schools and other schools, Indian Philosophy got developed.

119. Which is called Lokayata Darshan?

- (a) Jain (b) Bauddha
(c) Charvaka (d) Samkhya

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (c)

Charvaka philosophy is also known as Lokayata Darshan. It is an Indian materialistic philosophy that gives prominence to materialistic things and pleasures.

120. The Founder of Advait Philosophy is –

- (a) Sankaracharya (b) Ramanujacharya
(c) Madhvacharya (d) Mahatma Buddha
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

The principal exponent of the Advaita Vedanta interpretation was Adi Shankaracharya, who systematized the works of preceding philosophers.

121. Samkara's philosophy is called as

- (a) Monism (b) Integral Monism
(c) Dualism (d) Non-dualism

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (d)

Non-dualism philosophy is aptly described in Samkara's philosophy of Advaita Vedanta. It believes that Brahman is the one and only reality and everything else is mere illusion. Through knowledge of the identity of Atman (Soul) and Brahman one can attain Mukti (Salvation).

122. Who is called 'Crypto-Buddhist'?

- (a) Shamkara (b) Kapil
(c) Ramanuja (d) Patanjali

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (a)

Samkara or Adi Shankaracharya was propounder of Advaita philosophy in Hinduism. He included many Buddhist concepts in his philosophy due to which he is also known as Crypto-Buddhist.

123. By which of the following according to Advaita Vedanta, can Mukti be obtained?

- (a) Gyana (b) Karma
(c) Bhakti (d) Yoga
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

According to Advaita Vedanta, the Mukti (liberation) can be obtained by knowledge. It centers around knowledge and believes that correct understanding, provides knowledge of the identity of Atman (Soul) and Brahman which results in Mukti (liberation).

124. Who was the founder of Visistadvaita Siddhanta?

- (a) Ramanujacharya (b) Vallabhacharya
(c) Srikanthacharya (d) Madhavacharya

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (a)

Visistadvaita is one of the main branches of Vedanta. It is a Sanskrit term which means "non-dualism with differentiation". Vaishnavite Saint Ramanujacharya (C.1017-1137) is widely credited with spreading the philosophy of Vishishtadvaitavada.

125. Who among the following is not related to the Philosophy of Vedanta?

- (a) Shankaracharya (b) Abhinav Gupta
(c) Ramanuja (d) Madhava

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

Abhinav Gupta is not related to the philosophy of Vedanta. The thesis of Vedanta philosophy has an enormous impact on Hindu thought and culture. Shankaracharya (8th century), Ramanuja (11th century) and Madhava (13th century) were the giant scholars of Vedantic School, who gave varying interpretations of Vedanta philosophy.

126. Match List- I with List- II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List- I (Eras)

- A. Vikrama era B. Saka era
C. Gupta era D. Kali era

List- II (Reckoned from)

1. 3102 B.C. 2. 320 A.D.
3. 78 A.D. 4. 58 B.C.
5. 248 A.D.

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	5	1
(b)	1	3	2	4
(c)	4	5	2	3
(d)	4	3	2	1

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

Vikramaditya started Vikram era in 57 or 58 B.C. on the occasion of his victory over Saka. The Saka era was started by Kanishka in 78 A.D. The Gupta era was started by Chandragupta-I in 319 A.D. In this question it is matched with 320 A.D., which is nearest to it. Kali era is assumed to have been started in 3102 B.C.

127. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below:

1. Vikram Samvat began in 58 BC.
2. Saka Samvat began in 78 AD.
3. Gupta era began in 319 AD.
4. The era of Muslim rule in India began in 1192 AD.

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Vikram Samvat was launched in 57 or 58 BC, and Saka Samvat in 78 AD. Though Gupta dynasty was founded by Srigupta, the reign of Chandragupta-I is considered as the beginning of Gupta empire. Although, Muhammad Bin Qasim annexed Sindh region in the early 8th century, but the period of Muslim rule in India began in 1192 AD after the victory of Ghori in the battle of Tarain. Thus all statements mentioned in the question are correct.

128. Gandhaiya was a _____.

- (a) Coin (b) Land Tax
(c) Trade Tax (d) Military Officer

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Gadhaiya was a type of silver coin. These coins were promulgated on the lines of Sassanian coins.

129. The Badami rock inscription of Pulakesin I is dated in the Saka year 465. If the same were to be dated in Vikrama Samvat, the year would be :

- (a) 601 (b) 300
(c) 330 (d) 407

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

The Saka era started in 78 A.D. while Vikrama Samvat started from 57 or 58 B.C. So if we want to convert Badami rock inscription in Vikram Samvat then, it will be $465 + 78 + 58 = 601$ Vikram Samvat.

130. The Malaw Samvat was also known as :

- (a) Kalchuri Samvat (b) Krit Samvat
(c) Saka Samvat (d) Gupta Samvat

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Vikram Samvat is also known as Krit Samvat and Malav Samvat. Vikram Samvat or Vikram calendar is believed to have been started by King Vikramaditya and it starts in 57 or 58 B.C.

131. A Chalukya inscription is dated in the year 556 of the Saka era. It is equivalent to—

- (a) 478 A.D. (b) 499 A.D.
(c) 613 A.D. (d) 634 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (d)

Saka era was launched by Kanishka in 78 AD. If Chalukya inscription is dated in the year 556, then it is equivalent to $556 + 78 = 634$ A.D.

132. According to Puranas, the prime place of Chandravansh's ruler was —

- (a) Kasi (b) Ayodhya
(c) Pratihthanpur (d) Shravasti

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

According to Puranas, Chandravansha (or Somvansha) was one of the prime dynasties of Kshatriya Varna. The prime place of Chandravansh's ruler was Prayaga, but after a natural calamity. Dwapar Yug Chandravanshi King Samvaram established his capital in Pratihthanpur (at present Jhansi, Prayagraj).

133. The Capital of Maukharri was _____

- (a) Thanesar (b) Kannauj
(c) Purushpur (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Maukhari were the feudatories of Guptas who were basically from Gaya. The rulers of Maukhari dynasty made Kannauj their capital. Hari Varma, Aditya Varma, Ishan Varma, Sarva Varma and Graha Varma were chief rulers of this dynasty.

134. Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- (a) Sarvavarman - Gaya Copper Plate
(b) Ishwarverman - Jaunpur stone inscription
(c) Ishanverman - Harha stone inscription
(d) Jivit Gupta - Second - Deva Barnark inscription

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

A copper seal inscription of the Maukhari king Sarvavarman was (c. sixth century A.D.) found in the fort at Asirgarh, north of the city of Burhanpur, in Madhya Pradesh. The text of the inscription reveals the genealogy of the Maukhari kings, beginning with Harivarman.

135. From the decline of Guptas until the rise of Harshavardhana in the early seventh century, which of the following kingdoms were holding power in Northern India?

1. The Guptas of Magadha
2. The Paramaras of Malwa
3. The Pushyabhutis of Thanesar
4. The Maukharis of Kanauj
5. The Yadavas of Devagiri
6. The Maitrakas of Valabhi

Select the correct answer using the code given below

- (a) 1, 2 and 5 (b) 1, 3, 4 and 6
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 5 and 6

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

After the decline of the Guptas, the Later Guptas succeeded as the rulers of Magadha during the early seventh century. They ruled parts of the Northern India including Magadha (current day Bihar). Hence statement 1 is correct. The Paramara dynasty ruled the western and central parts of India including Malwa, between the 9th and 14th century AD, before being captured by Delhi Sultanate rulers. Hence statement 2 is not correct. The Pushyabhutis of Thanesar (current day Haryana) ruled various parts of Northern India during the 6th and 7th century AD. Hence statement 3 is correct. The Maukharis dynasty ruled over parts of Uttar Pradesh and Magadha including Kannauj. The dynasty ruled till around 606 AD when it was reconquered by the Later Guptas. Hence statement 4 is correct. The Yadavas of Devagiri ruled from around 1187 to 1317 AD in western parts of India. Hence statement 5 is not correct. The Maitrakas of Valabhi ruled western and northern parts of current-day Gujarat during the late 5th century to late 8th century AD. Hence statement 6 is correct. Therefore option (b) is correct option.

136. Who laid the foundation of Vardhana dynasty?

- (a) Pushyabhuti (b) Rajyavardhana
(c) Adityavardhana (d) Prabhakarvardhana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (a)

According to Banbhatt's composition Harshcharita the establishment of Vardhan dynasty was done by a person named Pushyabhuti, in Thaneshwar/Sthaneshwar. Harshvardhan was the greatest ruler of this dynasty.

137. Information regarding time of Harsha is contained in the books of :

- (a) Harisena (b) Kalhana
(c) Kalidasa (d) None of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Detailed information regarding Harsha is received from Harshacharita, written by Banabhatta who was court poet of Harsha. Some information regarding him is also available from Rajatarangini written by Kalhana. There is no information about Harsha in the books written by Kalidasa and Harisena.

138. Who has written the 'Harshacharita'?

- (a) Aryabhatta (b) Banabhatta
(c) Vishnugupta (d) Parimalgupta

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Eminent author Banabhatta composed the text "Harshacharita". This is the major source of Vardhana dynasty. It is a fable in which the author presents the description of his contemporary ruler and biographies of their ancestors.

139. The capital of Harsha's empire was –

- (a) Kannauj (b) Pataliputra
(c) Prayaga (d) Thanesar

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Chinese sources revealed that Harsha and Rajyashri ruled together over Kannauj. Harsha shifted his capital to Kannauj from Thanesar to help his sister Rajyashri in the proper administration of Kannauj. Kannauj was a suitable place to rule over the extensive empire of Harsha.

140. Emperor Harsha had shifted his capital from Thaneshwar to –

- (a) Prayaga (b) Delhi
(c) Kannauj (d) Rajgriha

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

141. Harshavardhana organised two great religious conventions in:

- (a) Kannauj and Prayaga
(b) Prayaga and Thaneshwar
(c) Thanesar and Vallabhi

(d) Vallabhi and Prayaga

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Harsha held a massive council of various religions and sects in Kannauj to prove the excellence of Mahayana over other religions. According to Chinese evidence, rulers of 20 countries, along with their eminent Brahmins, Shramanas, courtiers, etc., arrived there. This meeting was presided over by Hiuen Tsang. A function used to be held at Sangam region of Prayagraj every fifth year of Harsha's rule, which is stated as 'Mahamoksha council.' Hiuen Tsang himself attended the 6th function, which was attended by 18 rulers of various countries.

142. The place in U.P. where Harsh Vardhana organised the Buddha mega convention –

- (a) Kashi (b) Prayag
(c) Ayodhya (d) Sarnath

U.P. Lower (Sub.) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

143. Which of the following rulers ruled Assam in the time of Harsha?

- (a) Aswad Jahan
(b) Bhaskar Varman
(c) King Dahir
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

During the relevant period mentioned in the context, Bhaskar Varman ruled over Assam. Bhaskar Varman was the last ruler of the Varman dynasty.

144. Emperor Harsha's southward march was stopped on the Narmada river by :

- (a) Pulakesin-I (b) Pulakesin-II
(c) Vikramaditya-I (d) Vikramaditya -II

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

Emperor Harsha's southward march was stopped on the Narmada river by Pulakesin II, a Chalukyan ruler who defeated Harsha. This incident is mentioned in Aihole inscription of Pulakesin II and description of Hiuen Tsang.

145. Among the following rulers who had defeated Harshavardhana?

- (a) Kirtivarman II (b) Vikramaditya II
(c) Pulakesin I (d) Pulakesin II

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

146. The Chalukyan ruler Pulakesin's victory over Harsha was in the year –

- (a) 612 A.D. (b) 618 A.D.
(c) 622 A.D. (d) 634 A.D.

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Harsha's southward march was stopped on Narmada river by the Chalukya king Pulakesin who ruled over a great part of modern Karnataka and Maharashtra with his capital at Badami in the modern Bijapur district of Karnataka. The battle between Harsha and Pulakesin was fought sometime between 630 to 634 AD. The first reason in support of this battle is the result of the battle of Vallabhi which itself cannot be said to have been fought before 630 AD. Again Pulakesin's lohara inscription of 630 AD which mentions the names of his defeated enemies, does not include the name of Harsha, but Aihole inscription of 634 AD mentions this battle. In these conditions, the correct timing would be between 630 AD and 634 AD, so the nearest answer can be option (d). In April 2016, researchers from the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute claimed that the date of Pulakesin's great triumph over Harsha could be fixed at 618 AD. This information was based on a recently discovered copper plate inscription of Pulakesin II. Jharkhand Provincial Service Commission has accepted option (b) as the correct answer.

147. Poet Bana was an inhabitant of –

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Thanesar
(c) Bhojpur (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Banabhatta, the poet, was born in the village Prithikuta, on the bank of Son River in Aurangabad district (present Bihar). The name of his father and mother was Chitrabhanu and Rajdevi respectively.

148. In whose reign-period the Chinese Traveller Hiuen-Tsang visited India ?

- (a) Chandragupta - II (b) Harsh
(c) Chandragupta Maurya (d) Chandragupta - I

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

The arrival of Hiuen-Tsang was the most important event of Harsha's period. His desire was to visit the places related to Mahatma Buddha and study Buddhist texts, which was available in India. He departed for India in 629 AD from Changan, the capital of Tang Ruler. He wrote a book on his tour to India named 'Sei-Yu-Kei.'

149. Which Chinese traveller visited India during Harshavardhana's rules?

- (a) Fa-Hien (b) Hiuen-Tsang
(c) I-Tsing (d) Taranath

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

150. The Chinese traveller Yuan Chwang (Hiuen Tsang), who visited India recorded the general conditions and culture of India at that time. In this context, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The roads and river-routes were completely immune from robbery.
2. As regards punishment for offences ordeals by fire, water and poison were the instruments for determining the innocence or guilt of a person.
3. The tradesmen had to pay duties at ferries and barrier stations.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) Only 1 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Hiuen Tsang stayed in India and visited almost every province of the country. According to Hiuen Tsang, the roads and river-routes were not completely immune from robbery. He himself was robbed many times during his voyages and travels. Thus, statement (1) is incorrect. According to Hiuen Tsang, punishment for the crime was harsh during that time. Ordeals by fire, water and poison were used to determine the innocence or guilt of a person. From the records of Hiuen Tsang, this fact is highlighted that tax was levied on trade routes, banks of rivers, products and goods etc., by which the state collected an ample amount of money. Therefore, statements 2 and 3 are correct.

151. Who sent Hiuen-Tsang as an emissary to the court of Harsha ?

- (a) Taai-Sunga (b) Tung-Kuaan
(c) Ku-Yen-Vu (d) None of above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

Hiuen-Tsang was a contemporary of Taai-Sunga. Taai-Sunga had banned foreign tours in the West for his citizens, but Hiuen-Tsang came to India by silk-route in 629 AD. After 13 years of his migration, when he went back to China, the emperor welcomed him and appointed him as his spiritual advisor. On emperor's request, he composed his experiences in "A Record of the Western Regions."

152. During Hiuen Tsang's tour in India most famous city for the production of cotton clothes was –

- (a) Varanasi (b) Mathura
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kanchi

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The traveller from China Hiuen-Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and stayed here. According to Hiuen-Tsang, Mathura was famous for the production of cotton textiles. He also mentioned that the reason for the prosperity of Thanesar was its trade. Ujjayini as well as Kannauj were economically prosperous too.

153. The term 'Kausheya' has been used for –

- (a) Cotton (b) Flax
(c) Silk (d) Wool

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

In Gupta and later Gupta periods, the word 'Kausheya' was used to denote silk.

154. Chinese traveller Hiuen Tsang studied at the University of –

- (a) Taxila (b) Vikramshila
(c) Magadh (d) Nalanda

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The traveller from China, Hiuen Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and went to Nalanda University in 637 AD. Acharya Sheelbhadra was the Vice-Chancellor of Nalanda University at that time. He learned Yogashastra there, for almost one and half years. He also delivered a speech during his second visit to Nalanda University.

155. The major reason behind remembering Hiuen-Tsang is-

- (a) Respect for Harsha
(b) Study in Nalanda
(c) Trust in Buddhas
(d) Composition of Sei-Yu-Kei

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

Hiuen Tsang wrote a text 'Sei-yu-Kei' based on his journey. He is remembered for this composition as it consists of several information about ancient India.

156. The Chinese traveller who visited Bhinmal was :

- (a) Fahien (b) Sangyun
(c) Hieun Tsang (d) I-tsing

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

Hiuen Tsang was a Chinese traveller who arrived in India during Harsha's period. He also travelled to Bhinmal. His composition is known as 'Sei-Yu-Kei.' He was a Buddhist.

157. The famous Travelogue 'Si-Yu-Ki' is linked with

- (a) Fahien (b) Al Biruni
(c) Megasthenes (d) Hiuen-Tsang

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

Si-Yu-Ki is a Buddhist record composed by Chinese traveller Hiuen-Tsang. It contains the record of his travels.

158. Chinese traveller I-tsing was on the tour of Bihar in about

- (a) 405 A.D. (b) 635 A.D.
(c) 637 A.D. (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

With his desire to see the relics of Buddhism, Chinese traveller I-tsing (671-695 AD) with his 37 Buddhist associates decided to travel to western countries. Later his associates left him, and he alone moved to India from Canton city. He came to India through western sea route and returned to China via Sumatra.

159. Which of the following phrases defines the nature of the 'Hundi' generally referred to in the sources of the post-Harsha period?

- (a) An advisory issued by the king to his subordinates
(b) A diary to be maintained for daily accounts
(c) A bill of exchange
(d) An order from the feudal lord to his subordinates

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans (c)

In the sources of post-Harsha period, Hundi was treated as a 'bill of exchange'. As per RBI 'Hundis refer to financial instruments evolved on the Indian-subcontinent used in trade and credit transactions.'

160. Chinese writers mention India by the name of-

- (a) Fo-Kwo-ki (b) Yin-tu
(c) Si-Yu-Ki (d) Sikia-Pono

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

In ancient days, Chinese writers mentioned India by the name of 'Yin-tu' or 'Thian-tu' which means a variation of Hindu or Sindhu.

161. Nalanda University was destroyed by –

- (a) Muslims (b) Kushans
(c) Scythians (d) Mughals

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Nalanda University attracted scholars and students from Tibet, China, Greece and Persia. It was ransacked and destroyed by the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji at the end of the twelfth century. It can be seen as the coup de grace (final blow) to the decline of Buddhism in India.

162. The most ancient monastery in India is-

- (a) Nalanda (b) Udanpuri
(c) Vikramshila (d) Bhaja

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

In the above-given options, Nalanda is the most ancient monastery in Bihar. The history of Nalanda, the ancient university town of Bihar, goes back to the days of Buddha and Mahavira in the sixth century BC. However, excavations have not revealed anything to suggest that the site was occupied before the Gupta period (fifth century A.D.).

163. Nalanda is located in –

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Bihar

M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

164. During Post Gupta Period, main business center was –

- (a) Kannauj (b) Ujjain
(c) Dhar (d) Devgiri

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

During the post-Gupta period, the business center was shifted to Kannauj from Ujjain. During Gupta period, the importance of Ujjain increased as Chandragupta-II made it second capital. During post-Gupta period, Harsha made Kannauj capital in place of Thaneswar. As Kannauj was situated on the banks of Ganga and Jamuna, it was a place of business importance and became the center of attraction for three powers (Palas, Pratiharas and Rashtrakutas).

165. Assertion (A) : The main feature of the agrarian structure in the post-Gupta period was the development of feudalism.

Reason (R) : Land owner middle class and a dependent peasant class came into existence in this period.

Select the correct answer using the code given below : Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

Option (a) is correct because both assertion (A) and reason (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

166. Consider the following statements:

- The Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien attended the fourth Great Buddhist Council held by Kanishka**
- The Chinese pilgrim Hiuen-Tsang met Harsha and found him to be antagonistic to Buddhism**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 Only (b) 2 Only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien came to India during the reign of Chandragupta-II and travelled to various places of India. Chinese pilgrim Hiuen-Tsang travelled to India from Changan, the capital of Tang rulers in 629 AD. Harsha had already leaned towards Buddhism before meeting Hiuen-Tsang. After meeting Hiuen-Tsang, Harsha granted royal patronage to "Mahayana", a branch of Buddhism and became Buddhist.

167. Consider the following statements :

- Fa-Hien was a Chinese pilgrim who visited India during the reign of Harsha.**
- Hiuen Tsang was a Chinese Buddhist monk who visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

168. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

Foreign Travellers	Year/s of Tour to India
(a) Fa-Hien	– 399-414 A.D.
(b) Hiuen-Tsang	– 629-645 A.D.
(c) I-tsing	– 679-695 A.D.
(d) Al-Masudi	– 957 A.D.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (*)

I-tsing visited India during 671 AD-695 AD. Al Masudi visited in 915-16 AD. Fa-Hien travelled India only for 10 years (402 AD - 412 AD) while his entire trip from China occurred during 399-414 AD. Hiuen-Tsang visited India during 629-645 A.D.

169. Consider the following foreign travellers and arrange them in ascending chronological order:

1. I-tsing 2. Al-Biruni.
3. Hiuen Tsang 4. Fa-Hien

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 4, 3, 1, 2
- (c) 2, 1, 4, 3 (d) 3, 4, 2, 1

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Fa-Hien's visit to India lasted only 10 years (402 CE to 412 CE), while his overall journey from China lasted from 399 CE to 414 CE. Hiuen Tsang's (Xuanzang's) visit to India lasted from 629 CE to 645 CE. I-tsing visited India from 671 CE to 695 CE. Al-Biruni arrived in India with Mahmud of Ghazni (during the 11th century). Thus, the correct answer is option (b).

170. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

1. **The Sun temple of Multan is mentioned by Hiuen Tsang, Abuzaiyid, Al-Masudi and Alberuni.**
2. **The pilgrimage to Sambapur was associated with Sun worship.**

Codes :

- (a) Only 1 is correct
- (b) Only 2 is correct
- (c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

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Ans (c)

Sun temple of Multan is mentioned by Hiuen Tsang, Al-Masudi & Alberuni. Hence (1) is correct. Pilgrimage to Sambpur was associated with Sun worship. So statement (2) is also correct. Therefore correct option is (c).

171. With reference to Indian history, which of the following is/are the essential element/elements of the feudal system?

1. **A very strong centralized political authority and a very weak provincial or local political authority**
2. **Emergence of administrative structure based on control and possession of land**
3. **Creation of lord-vassal relationship between the feudal lord and his overlord**

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

India has a specific significance in the context of the feudal system. The system was laid during Saka-Kushan period, and it gained its height during the Rajput period. The feudal system in India remained an integral part of administration during Kushanas, Rajputs, Sultanate and Mughal periods. The feudal system had a strong authority which used to divide their empires into several parts and navigate it through feudalism. Feudals were relatively in a weak position, as they used to follow the orders and instructions of the king's central authority. Feudals had the right to collect tax and right to govern. The relationship of master and slave between the king and feudal is not found in the Indian context. Indian feudal system was different from the feudal system of Europe. It also shows the emergence of administrative structure based on control and possession of the land.

172. Who is the author of the Sondani inscription of Yashodharman?

- (a) Kavi Madan (b) Vasula Kavi
- (c) Kakk (d) Ravikirti

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Vasula Kavi is the composer of Yashodharman's Sondani/ Sondhni inscription. This inscription is considered an important historical and literary document of Yashodharman's reign. It provides information about King Yashodharman's victories and governance.

173. Which one of the following statements is not true for Shankaracharya, Saint of the 8th century?

- (a) He established four religious centers in different parts of India
- (b) He countered the spread of Buddhism and Jainism.
- (c) He named Prayag as Teerthraj
- (d) He propagated Vedanta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Shankaracharya also named as Shankara was born in Kaladi, a small village in Kerala in the 8th century. At this time, Hinduism which had diminished in status due to arrival of Jainism and Buddhism again rose to eminence with the emergence of Shankaracharya. He advocated the greatness of the Vedanta. To study and compile the Vedas, he travelled all over India on foot. His philosophy is known as Advaita Vedanta. The four religious centers established by Shankaracharya are considered as the most important centers of Hinduism.

174. Adi Shankar who later became Shankaracharya was born in :

- (a) Kashmir (b) Kerala
- (c) Andhra Pradesh (d) West Bengal

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

175. Where are the four monasteries established by Adi 'Shankaracharya' situated?

- (a) Sringeri, Dwarka, Joshimath, Prayaga
- (b) Dwarka, Joshimath, Prayaga, Kanchi
- (c) Joshimath, Dwarka, Puri, Sringeri
- (d) Puri, Sringeri, Dwarka, Varanasi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Badrinath, Dwarka, Puri, and Rameshwaram are the 'Chardham' while Gangotri, Yamunotri, Kedarnath and Badrinath are the little Chardham located in Uttarakhand. The four monasteries established by Adi Shankaracharya are- Jyotirmath (North), Sringeri (South), Puri (East) and Dwarka (West).

176. Which of the following is not included in Chardham?

- (a) Puri
- (b) Dwaraka
- (c) Mansarovar
- (d) Rameshwaram

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

177. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched:

- (a) Ravi Kirti – Pulakesin II
- (b) Bhavabhuti – Yasovarman of Kannauj
- (c) Harisena – Harsha
- (d) Dandi – Narasimha Varman

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Harisena was the compiler of Prayaga Prashasti and secretary of Samudragupta while Banabhatta was the poet laureate of Harsha. Other options are correctly matched.

178. Match List- I with List- II and choose the answer according to the code-

List - I

(Courtier poet)

- A. Amir Khusro
- B. Kalidas
- C. Harisena
- D. Banabhatta

List - II

(King)

- 1. Chandragupta II
- 2. Samudragupta
- 3. Harshvardhan
- 4. Alauddin Khalji

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (c) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

Amir Khusro was the poet laureate of Alauddin Khalji. Kalidas was the poet laureate of Chandragupta II and one of the 'Navratna' of his court. Harisena was the loyal secretary of Samudragupta and Banabhatta was the poet laureate of Harshvardhan.

179. Match the following and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- | | |
|------------------------|--------------------|
| A. Bhoj | 1. Ujjain |
| B. Durgawati | 2. Vidisha |
| C. Samudragupta | 3. Dhar |
| D. Ashoka | 4. Gondwana |

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (c) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

- | | | |
|--------------|---|----------|
| Bhoj | - | Dhar |
| Durgawati | - | Gondwana |
| Samudragupta | - | Vidisha |
| Ashoka | - | Ujjain |

180. With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs :

(Famous Place)

(Present State)

- | | | |
|------------------------|----------|-----------------------|
| 1. Bhilsa | - | Madhya Pradesh |
| 2. Dwarasamudra | - | Maharashtra |
| 3. Girinagar | - | Gujarat |
| 4. Sthanesvara | - | Uttar Pradesh |

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 3 only | (b) 1 and 4 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 2 and 4 only |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

Bhilsa is an archaeological site in Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh. 'Dwarasamudra' was capital of the Hoysala dynasty which ruled the modern Karnataka area. Girinar is a group of mountains in the Junagarh district of Gujarat. Sthanesvara (Thanesar) is a historic town and important Hindu pilgrimage center on the banks of the Saraswati River in Haryana.